

OUR TOWN



Actor Packet
Compiled by Anna Jennings

LUCINDA MATLOCK*

I went to the dances at Chandlerville,
 And played snap-out at Winchester.
 One time we changed partners,
 Driving home in the moonlight of middle June,
 And then I found Davis.
 We were married and lived together for seventy
 years,
 Enjoying, working, raising the twelve children,
 Eight of whom we lost
 Ere I had reached the age of sixty.
 I spun, I wove, I kept the house, I nursed the sick,
 I made the garden, and for holiday
 Rambled over the fields where sang the larks,
 And by Spoon River gathering many a shell,
 And many a flower and medicinal weed—
 Shouting to the wooded hills, singing to the
 green valleys.
 At ninety-six I had lived enough, that is all,
 And passed to a sweet repose.
 What is this I hear of sorrow and weariness,
 Anger, discontent and drooping hopes?
 Degenerate sons and daughters,
 Life is too strong for you—
 It takes life to love Life.

DAVIS MATLOCK*

Suppose it is nothing but the hive:
 That there are drones and workers
 And queens, and nothing but storing honey—
 (Material things as well as culture and wisdom)—
 For the next generation, this generation never
 living,
 Except as it swarms in the sun-light of youth,
 Strengthening its wings on what has been
 gathered,
 And tasting, on the way to the hive
 From the clover field, the delicate spoil.
 Suppose all this, and suppose the truth:
 That the nature of man is greater
 Than nature's need in the hive;
 And you must bear the burden of life,
 As well as the urge from your spirit's excess—
 Well, I say to live it out like a god
 Sure of immortal life, though you are in doubt,
 Is the way to live it.
 If that doesn't make God proud of you
 Then God is nothing but gravitation,
 Or sleep is the golden goal.

HUMANITIES

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Student

How the Once-Banned *Spoon River Anthology* Made a Comeback in Lewistown

Poetic justice in small-town America

Laura Wolff Scanlan

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ILLINOIS

When *Spoon River Anthology* was published in 1915, Edgar Lee Masters shattered the myth of small-town America as the bastion of American virtue. In his thinly veiled fictional town of Spoon River, situated in central Illinois near Lewistown, where Masters grew up, the honest, hardworking, chaste, and churchgoing live amidst corrupt bankers, abusive husbands, unfulfilled wives, sexual deviants, and failed dreamers.

“Although such experiences and views were part of American culture, poets had not written about them before,” says John E. Hallwas, author of *Spoon River Anthology: An Annotated Edition*.

In the groundbreaking work, Masters, a onetime law partner of Clarence Darrow, gives voice to more than two hundred deceased citizens of Spoon River who are laid to rest in Oak Hill Cemetery, known to the locals as The Hill. Freed by the shackles of life, the un-living who “sleep beneath these weeds”

confess their deepest secrets, disappointments, frustrations, joys, and warnings to the living in the form of brutally honest free verse poems. “No volume of poetry since Whitman’s *Leaves of Grass* had attempted so much or had been so original,” says Hallwas.

Each postmortem poem in the collection is titled with the name of the citizen who reveals some truth about their daily existence in Spoon River. Masters gleaned tidbits of stories and gossip he heard during the time he spent in Lewistown and nearby Petersburg, where his grandparents lived. In some cases, Masters barely changed their names. Henry Phipps was really banker Henry Phelps. Harry Wilmans was Henry Wilmans. In a few instances, he used real names, such as William H. Herndon, the law partner of Abraham Lincoln, and Anne Rutledge, considered Lincoln’s first love.

Meant to be read as a novel, the reader is required to piece together narratives from single lines and fragments contained in individual poems. Minerva Jones tells us she was raped by Butch Weldy and died during an abortion. Doctor Meyers, the abortionist, blames Minerva for his own death in jail saying, “I tried to help her out.” Mrs. Meyers, the doctor’s wife, believes her husband deserved the town’s scorn for breaking “the law human and divine.” Butch Weldy, on the other hand, never mentions the rape but tells us he “got religion and steadied down.”

The book was a literary sensation and huge commercial success. Carl Sandburg wrote in the *Little Review*, “The people whose faces look out from the pages of the book are the people of life itself, each trait of them as plain or as mysterious as in the old home valley where the writer came from. Such a writer and book are realized here.” Ezra Pound rejoiced in the *London Egoist*: “At last the American West has produced a poet . . . capable of dealing with life directly, without circumlocution, without resonant meaningless phrases. Ready to say what he has to say, and shut up when he [has] said it.” It was an international best-seller, reported to have sold 80,000 copies in four years. Masters himself boasted that it “broke the record in America for the sale of a book of verse.”

Back in Lewistown, however, the villagers were not so enthusiastic. On the contrary, they were furious with “that scoundrel Masters.” “After all,” says Hallwas, “he often exposed the troubled lives of people.” Even though most names were fictitious, everyone in town knew exactly who he was talking about. Because of this, the book was immediately banned from schools and libraries in the area, including the Lewistown library, where Masters’s mother worked as a librarian. Although the book was not available in the area, some found a way to obtain a secret copy, which they talked about only in whispers.

Masters was interested in writing from a very young age, but was encouraged to follow in his father’s footsteps as a lawyer. He was admitted to the bar in 1891 and left Lewistown to build a law practice in Chicago. In his off time, he wrote poetry and plays with little success. Masters became acquainted with

writers who would become known as the Chicago Renaissance, including Sandburg, Sherwood Anderson, and Theodore Dreiser, who Masters honors with a poem titled “Theodore the Poet” in the *Anthology*.

After reading *Epigrams from Greek Anthology*, Masters experimented with the epigram form and submitted some poems he wrote to *Reedy's Mirror*, a literary magazine in St. Louis. The poems were serialized in 1914 under the pseudonym Webster Ford for fear of damaging Masters's law practice. His real identity was revealed later that year by *Mirror* editor William Reedy, who asserted Masters's work was “a great work of literary art.”

With the success of *Spoon River Anthology*, Masters left his law practice to write full time and moved to New York in 1920. Although he would write more than 50 books, including novels, plays, poetry, and biographies of Mark Twain, Walt Whitman, and Abraham Lincoln, he never equaled the success he had with *Spoon River Anthology*.

The wounds have healed in Lewistown as successive generations joined their family and friends on The Hill. The book's banning was lifted in 1974. Masters and *Spoon River Anthology* are now celebrated throughout the year in Lewistown. To commemorate its 100-year anniversary, Lewistown is hosting several events, including Oak Hill Cemetery tours, exhibitions, theatrical performances, and walking tours. As part of the Illinois Humanities Speakers Bureau, Paddy Lynn, Jon Lynn, and Patti Ecker perform dramatic readings throughout the state, and Hallwas gives his talk, “Poets of Community and Human Struggle: Edgar Lee Masters and Carl Sandburg.”

Masters died in 1950 and is buried at Oakland Cemetery in Petersburg. In 1970, the U.S. Postal Service issued a stamp in his honor.

The work continues to stay relevant for its treatment of the human condition says Hallwas. It has never been out of print, has been adapted for stage and screen, taught in acting classes, translated into numerous languages, and phrases from “Alexander Throckmorton” were quoted by Pope Francis during his recent visit to America.

About the author

Laura Wolff Scanlan is a writer in Wheaton, Illinois.

Our Town Glossary

Compiled by Kamilah Bush for Triad Stage's 2018 production:

<https://sites.google.com/view/ourtowndramaturgy/glossary?authuser=0>

Canuck – A Canadian, specifically a French Canadian - this term is most often a slur.

Presbyterian – A protestant denomination originating in the British Isles and Scotland in the 16th century. Presbyterian theology typically emphasizes the sovereignty of God, the authority of the Scriptures, and the necessity of grace through faith in Christ. Presbyterians distinguish themselves from other denominations by doctrine, institutional organization (or "church order") and worship; often using a "Book of Order" to regulate common practice and order.

Methodist – A protestant denomination originating in the British Empire during the 18th century. Most Methodists teach that Jesus Christ, the Son of God, died for all of humanity and that salvation is available for all.

Unitarian – A Christian theological practice, originating in the mid-16th century, which rejects the Holy Trinity, asserting that Jesus was inspired by God in his moral teachings, and he is a savior, but he was a normal human being and not a deity or God incarnate.

Holla' – "Hollow," a small rising valley region between two hills or mountains; often containing a creek

Hollyhock



Heliotrope



Burdock



Butternut Tree



Congregational Church – Protestant denomination originating in the Plymouth and Massachusetts Bay colonies in 1648. Congregational churches in the Reformed tradition practice congregationalist church governance, in which each congregation independently and autonomously runs its own affairs.

"...it always tells me when it's going to rain." – There are theories that changes in barometric pressure in the weather, as well as temperatures and humidity can trigger chronic joint pain sufferers' aches.

Massachusetts Tech – Refers to what we know as MIT, a private research university in Cambridge, Massachusetts, United States. Founded in 1861 in response to the increasing industrialization of the United States, MIT adopted a European polytechnic university model and stressed laboratory instruction in applied science and engineering.

"...the war broke out." – Refers to WWI - also known as the First World War, the Great War, or the War to End All Wars, was a global war originating in Europe that lasted from 28 July 1914 to 11 November 1918. More than 70 million military personnel, including 60 million Europeans, were mobilized in one of the largest wars in history

Separator – a centrifugal device that separates milk into cream and skimmed milk. Separation was commonly performed on farms in the past. Most farmers milked a few cows, usually by hand, and separated milk. Some of the skimmed milk was consumed while the rest was used to feed calves and pigs. Enough cream was saved to make butter, and the excess was sold.

Forty Winks – to take a nap for a short period of time (usually not in bed), or to take a short sleep during the day

Strawberry phosphates – a type of beverage that has a tangy or sour taste. These beverages became popular among children in the 1870s in the United States. Phosphate beverages were made with fruit flavorings, egg, malt, or wine. In the 1900s, the beverages became popular, and fruit-flavored phosphate sodas were served at soda fountains.

"String some of these beans" – A process by which green beans are prepared before cooking or canning. Grasp the end of a bean firmly between your thumb and index finger. Twist the tip down toward its seam with a quick, even motion. A fresh bean should snap readily. Draw the broken tip down along the seam to remove the tough fiber that may be present. Most green beans available today do not have this "string," but heirloom varieties may. Snap off the other end of the bean in the same way. Discard the snapped-off ends and any fibers in the small bowl.



Highboy – A tall chest of drawers on legs

Napoleon – A French statesman and military leader who was the Emperor of the French from 1804-1815 (briefly) and took control of most of the European continent in that time.

Antietam – The Battle of Antietam (ant-EE-dum), or as it is known in much of the South, the Battle of Sharpsburg, took place on September 17, 1862 near Sharpsburg, (just over 400 miles from where Grover's Corners is supposed to be). It is the single bloodiest day in American history, with a death toll of nearly 23,000. It was also the first battle of the U.S. Civil War to take place on Union soil.

Pleistocene granite – Granite having formed during the earlier half of the Quaternary Period, beginning about two million years ago and ending 10,000 years ago, characterized by widespread glacial ice and the advent of modern humans.

Appalachian Range – Appalachia is a large expanse of the North American continent stretching 205,000-square-miles from southern New York to northern Mississippi and touching parts of 13 states. The region is home to approximately 25 million people in 420 counties. The Appalachian Mountain range began forming nearly 480 million years ago and its highest group is Mount Mitchell in North Carolina at 6,684 feet (2,037 m), which is the highest point in the United States east of the Mississippi River.

Devonian Basalt – a geologic period and system of the Paleozoic, spanning 60 million years from the end of the Silurian, 419.2 million years ago (Mya), to the beginning of the Carboniferous, 358.9 Mya. It is named after Devon, England, where rocks from this period were first studied.

Mesozoic Shale – a fine-grained, clastic sedimentary rock composed of mud that is a mix of flakes of clay minerals and tiny fragments (silt-sized particles) of other minerals, especially quartz and calcite having formed during an interval of geological time from about 252 to 66 million years ago.

Sandstone – a clastic sedimentary rock composed mainly of sand-sized (0.0625 to 2 mm) mineral particles or rock fragments.

Amerindian – another term for American Indian, used chiefly in anthropological and linguistic contexts.

Cotahatchee – This Native American tribe appears to be Wilder's own invention. The tribe in the area where Grover's Corners is set would have been the Missisquoi or the Abenaki people.

English brachiocephalic – May refer to *brachycephalic* which is a relatively broad, short skull (usually with the breadth at least 80 percent of the length).

MacPhearson's Gauge – Logan Grant MacPherson (1863-1925) was "an authority on population figures". MacPherson "was employed by American railroads as a statistician, and his computations were used by government and commercial agencies." Presumably 6.032 people die each year in Grover's Corners? The birth and mortality rates are constant, so the same number of people is born each year as dies.

Board of Selectmen – Historically, in most New England towns, the adult voting population gathered annually in a town meeting to act as the local legislature, approving budgets and laws. Day-to-day operations were originally left to individual oversight, but when towns became too large for individuals to handle such workloads, they would elect an executive board of, literally, select(ed) men to run things for them. Typically,

there are three men who are selectmen and, basically, they comprise the executive branch of the town's government.

Robinson Crusoe – Published in 1719, this novel tells the story of the titular character who has been a castaway for 28 years on a remote island near Trinidad.

Monroe Doctrine – a piece of U.S. foreign policy dating from 1823. At a time when many South American nations were gaining independence from Spain and Portugal, the Monroe Doctrine held that any European intervention in North or South America would be considered an act of aggression against the United States. This was not United States law per se but rather Executive policy.

Louisiana Purchase – The Louisiana Territory was purchased 1803 from France under the presidency of Thomas Jefferson. The purchase was of 828,000 square miles.

Telegraph – The electric telegraph was developed earlier but really became a technology in common use in the 1830s. It sent electric currents along wires in order to relay messages. Needles could point to specific letters and could be interpreted by operators. With Morse code, this could work faster, but it was still dependent on operators. By the turn of the century, electric telegraphs were able to work at speeds of (a very fast) 70 words a minute.

"Vermont for the marble" – New Hampshire does actually have plenty of marble, but the good marble is always thought to come from Vermont. It is a bit of a point of pride for Vermonters and a source of irritation for any resident of New Hampshire, thus the stage-manager's "sorry to say".

Silicate glue – They are covering the reading material in sodium silicate in order to keep out air and other things that will rot the paper.

Treaty of Versailles – World War I officially ended with the signing of the Treaty of Versailles on June 28, 1919. Negotiated among the Allied powers with little participation by Germany, its 15 parts and 440 articles reassigned German boundaries and assigned liability for reparations.

Lindbergh Flight – Charles Lindbergh, a 25-year-old U.S. Air Mail pilot, emerged suddenly from virtual obscurity to instantaneous world fame as the result of his solo, non-stop flight on May 20–21, 1927 from Roosevelt Field in Garden City, Long Island to Le Bourget Field in (here it is again) Paris, France. The flight was a distance of nearly 3,600 statute miles; Lindbergh flew in a single-seat, single-engine plane called the Spirit of St. Louis. As a result of this flight, Lindbergh was the first person in history to be in New York one day and Paris the next. Lindbergh, a U.S. Army Air Corps Reserve officer, was also awarded the nation's highest military decoration, the Medal of Honor, for this historic exploit

Potato weather – Potato planting requires timing between hard freezes and hot temperatures. Depending on local weather, most gardeners plant in March, April, or May, and expect a harvest about four months later, starting to dig new potatoes about two to three weeks after plants flower.

Cicero's Orations – *O tempora, O mores!* The Catiline Orations, as they are now known, were speeches given in 63 BCE by Marcus Tullius Cicero, the consul of Rome, exposing to the Roman Senate the plot of Lucius Sergius Catilina and his allies to overthrow the government. The famous opening lines are: *How long, O Catiline, will you abuse our patience? And for how long will that madness of yours mock us? To what end will your unbridled audacity hurl itself?*

Parson – a beneficed member of the clergy; a rector or a vicar.

Overshoes – There are two basic types. One is like an oversize shoe or low boot made of thick rubber with a heavy sole and instep, designed for heavy-duty use. The other one is of much thinner, more flexible material, more like a rubber slipper, designed solely for protection against the wet rather than for extensive walking.

Philo System – The Philo System of Progressive Poultry Keeping is a real book written by Edgar Philo and published in 1908 which advocates improved chicken management by informing readers of precise details of chicken management. He advocated, for instance, that chickens be kept in small flocks of 10 instead of large flocks of sixty. He noted that 10 hens would lay 60 eggs in 7 days, or one egg a day per week per hen with one day off. But a large coop of 100 chickens would not lay 600 eggs a week; they were too stressed. Dividing them back into small groups increased egg production to the fabled 600 eggs per week.

Ice Cream Soda – Similar to an ice cream float, wherein soda water, syrups and ice cream are mixed together in a dessert drink.

State Agriculture College – Now called the University of New Hampshire, the New Hampshire College of Agriculture and the Mechanic Arts was originally attached to Dartmouth College and was housed in Hanover NH. In 1893 it moved to Durham,

Cattle judging – the process of judging a series of cattle and pronouncing a first-, second- and third-place animal based on each animal's individual traits compared to that of the others. Most cattle judging occurs in show rings at agricultural shows. Judgments on cattle are ultimately based on which animal is worth the most profit. There are many fine points to cattle judging. In a beef animal, for example, it is desirable to have a large animal with muscle development. In a dairy cow, however, the judge would look for characteristics that would help to produce the best possible milk. When judging cattle, there is an overjudge, who looks at all of the cattle and puts them in order of 'best' animal to 'worst' animal.

"The go-cart" – a small carriage for young children to ride in; stroller. or a small framework with casters, wheels, etc., in which children learn to walk; walker.

Mountain Laurel



Lilacs



Daughters of the American Revolution - A lineage-based membership service organization for women who are directly descended from a person involved in the United States' struggle for independence. They promote historic preservation, education and patriotism.

Mayflower – an English ship that famously transported the first English Puritans, known today as the Pilgrims, from Plymouth, England to the New World in 1620. There were 102 passengers, and the crew is estimated to have been about 30, but the exact number is unknown. This voyage has become an iconic story in some of the earliest annals of American history, with its story of death and of survival in the harsh New England winter environment. The culmination of the voyage in the signing of the Mayflower Compact was an event which established a rudimentary form of democracy, with each member contributing to the welfare of the community

Lumbago – lower back pain or pain in the lumbar region of the spine.

Livery stable – A livery stable was a stable where horses, teams, and wagons were for hire, but also where privately owned horses could be boarded for a short time, often attached to a hotel or boarding house. The livery stable was a necessary institution of every US American town. In addition to providing vital transportation service, the livery was the source of hay, grain, coal, and wood. Because of the stench, noise, and vermin that surrounded the livery, cities and towns attempted to control their locations and activities. Because of their location on a town's outskirts, livery stables were often the scene of gambling and cockfighting, and they were often condemned as sources of vice. With the advent of the automobile after 1910, livery stables all over the country quietly disappeared.

Hamilton College – a private, nonsectarian liberal arts college located in the village of Clinton, New York, in the Mohawk Valley foothills of the Adirondack Mountains. Founded as an academy in 1793, it was chartered as Hamilton College in 1812 (named for charter trustee Alexander Hamilton).

Locations

Canton, Ohio – city in and the county seat of Stark County, Ohio, United States. Founded in 1805 alongside the Middle and West Branches of Nimishillen Creek, Canton became a heavy manufacturing center because of its numerous railroad lines. However, its status in that regard began to decline during the late 20th century, as shifts in the manufacturing industry led to the relocation or repositioning of many factories. After this decline, the city's industry diversified into the service economy, including retailing, education, finance and healthcare.

Concord, New Hampshire – The capital of New Hampshire (pron. CON-curd): in the Southern third of the state but about halfway between the eastern and western borders

Boston, Massachusetts – the capital city and most populous municipality of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts. Boston is one of the oldest cities in the United States, founded on the Shawmut Peninsula in 1630 by Puritan settlers from England.

Gettysburg – A town in Pennsylvania where the Battle of Gettysburg took place - fought July 1–3, 1863, by Union and Confederate forces during the American Civil War. The battle involved the largest number of casualties of the entire war and is often described as the war's turning point. Union Maj. Gen. George Meade's Army of the Potomac defeated attacks by Confederate Gen. Robert E. Lee's Army of Northern Virginia, halting Lee's invasion of the North.

Contoocook – a village and census-designated place within the town of Hopkinton in Merrimack County, New Hampshire. The village is named after the Contoocook River that runs through it. The name Contoocook came from the Pennacook tribe of Native Americans and means "place of the river near pines".

Lake Sunapee – Lake Sunapee (SUN-uh-pee) is in West Central New Hampshire. North of Grover's Corners and perhaps a bit west of it.

Lake Winnepesaukee – Lake Winnepesaukee (winnipuh-SAW-kee) is much farther north of Sunapee and farther east in the true center of the state. It is also much bigger

White Mountains – The White Mountains cover most of New Hampshire beginning in the south from around Lake Sunapee and curving north of Lake Winnepesaukee. They are a part of the Appalachian Range. These mountains are a very big deal in New Hampshire, and tourists come from miles away to see the leaves turn color in the autumn.

Mt. Washington – Mt. Washington is the highest peak in the Northeastern United States and is a part of the White Mountains. It is, it must be noted, extremely far from where Grover's Corners is supposed to be near the Massachusetts/New Hampshire border.

North Conway/Conway – Towns far to the east in New Hampshire. Conway and North Conway lie close to the Maine border just south of Mount Washington

Mt. Monadnock – Mt. Monadnock (muh-NAD-nock) is famous for appearing in the writings of Emerson and Thoreau. This mountain is surrounded by the towns mentioned in the play (Jaffrey, East Jaffrey, Peterborough, Dublin), as well as by Troy and Marlborough. All of this area of New Hampshire is much closer to the Massachusetts border

Jaffrey – a town in Cheshire County, New Hampshire located along the Contoocook River at the junction of U.S. Route 202 and New Hampshire routes 124 and 137.

East Jaffrey – a historic district running roughly along NH Route 124 (Main Street) through Jaffrey, New Hampshire. It encompasses what is now the economic and civic heart of the town, centered on the Jaffrey Mills and the crossing of the Contoocook River by Route 124.

Peterborough – a town in Hillsborough County, New Hampshire located along the Contoocook River at the junction of U.S. Route 202 and New Hampshire Route 101. The community is 38 miles west of Manchester and 72 miles northwest of Boston.

Dublin – a town in Cheshire County, New Hampshire, The northern slopes of Mount Monadnock occupy the southern part of town. The highest point in Dublin is along Monadnock's northeast ridge. Roughly the western half of Dublin lies within the Connecticut River watershed, drained by tributaries of the Ashuelot River, with the eastern half located in the Merrimack River watershed, drained by tributaries of the Contoocook River. The town is crossed by New Hampshire Route 101 and New Hampshire Route 137.

Woodlawn – also known as Woodlawn Heights, is an Irish American working class neighborhood at the very north end of the borough of the Bronx, in New York City

Brooklyn – Most likely a reference to the Cemetery of the Evergreens in Brooklyn and Queens. In the late 1920s it was the busiest cemetery in New York City

Crawford Notch – a major pass through the White Mountains of New Hampshire, located almost entirely within the town of Hart's Location. Roughly half of that town is contained in Crawford Notch State Park. The high point of the notch, at approximately 1,900 feet (580 m) above sea level, is at the southern end of the town of Carroll, near the Crawford Depot train station and Saco Lake, the source of the Saco River, which flows southward through the steep-sided notch. North of the high point of the notch, Crawford Brook flows more gently northwest to the Ammonoosuc River, a tributary of the Connecticut River.

Buffalo, NY – The second-largest city in the U.S. state of New York and the 81st-most populous city in the United States. The Buffalo area was inhabited before the 17th century by the Iroquois tribe and later by French settlers. The city grew significantly in the 19th and 20th centuries as a result of immigration, the construction of the Erie Canal, the building of railroads and its close proximity to Lake Erie, providing an abundance of fresh water and an ample trade route to the Midwestern United States, while grooming its economy for the grain, steel and automobile industries that dominated the city's economy during the 20th century.

Clinton, NY. – the Village of Clinton in Oneida County in central New York: the site of Hamilton College.

History

POP Culture: 1900

ICONS: "Wright Brothers, Pablo Picasso, Ford Model T



- Kodak® introduces the "Brownie" camera in February 1900.
- On September 6, 1901, Leon Czolgosz shot President William McKinley. He died at 2:15 a.m. on September 14 and Vice-President Theodore Roosevelt was sworn in as president later that day.
- Composer and musician Scott Joplin publishes *The Entertainer* in 1902.
- The January 22, 1903, Hay-Herran Treaty grants the United States a renewable lease in perpetuity from Colombia on the land proposed for the Panama Canal.
- On February 14, 1903, the U.S. Census Bureau becomes part of the new U.S. Department of Commerce and Labor.
- The first silent film, *The Great Train Robbery*, debuts in 1903.
- Orville and Wilbur Wright are first to fly a controlled, powered, and sustained heavier-than-air airplane at Kitty Hawk, NC, on December 17, 1903.
- Prominent civil and women's rights leader Susan B. Anthony dies on March 13, 1906.
- The first underground portion of the New York City subway opens on October 27, 1904.
- At 5:12 a.m. on April 18, 1906, the "Great San Francisco Earthquake" strikes.
- Artist Pablo Picasso introduces Cubism in 1907.
- An explosion in West Virginia's Monongah Mine on December 6, 1907, becomes the nation's worst industrial disaster. The "official" number of deaths was 362 adult and child miners, but later estimates exceed 500.
- Henry Ford begins production of the Model T in 1908.
- The National Association for the Advancement of Colored People (NAACP) is founded on February 12, 1909.
- The U.S. Mint introduces the "Lincoln Head" penny in 1909.

The 1900 Census	
U.S. Resident Population:	76,212,168
Population per square mile of land area:	21.5
Percent increase of population from 1890 to 1900:	21.0
Official Enumeration Date:	June 1
Number of States:	45
Cost:	\$11,854,000
Cost per Capita (cents):	15.5
Total Pages in Published Reports:	10,925
Number of Enumerators:	52,871
Census Bureau Director:	William Rush Merriam
Number of Questions Asked:	28

10 Largest Urban Places		
Rank	Place	Population
1	New York City, NY	3,437,202
2	Chicago, IL	1,698,575
3	Philadelphia, PA	1,293,697
4	St. Louis, MO	575,238
5	Boston, MA	560,892
6	Baltimore, MD	508,957
7	Cleveland, OH	381,768
8	Buffalo, NY	352,387
9	San Francisco, CA	342,782
10	Cincinnati, OH	325,902